There was no mention of Turkey. The President's response to demands about 'analogous weapons' in Turkey was to be given orally to Ambassador Dobrynin by Robert Kennedy. If Saturday, 27 October was the most dangerous day in human history, then it might be argued that the meeting between the US Attorney General and the Soviet Ambassador was the most important encounter in the history of diplomacy. The President entrusted this crucial mission to the least diplomatic member of his administration. Despite coaching from Ambassador Thompson, the task was left to an Attorney General, who owed his position in government to nepotism, who had no experience of, or aptitude for, diplomacy, and who possessed a volatile temperament that was frequently apparent in the ExComm meetings.

The most influential account of Robert Kennedy's meeting with Anatoly Dobrynin is in *Thirteen Days*, posthumously published in 1969, after Robert Kennedy's assassination the previous year:

> He asked me what offer the United States was making, and I told him of the letter that President Kennedy had just transmitted to Khrushchev. He raised the question of our removing the missiles from Turkey. I said that there could be no quid pro quo, or any arrangement made under this kind of threat or pressure, and that in the last analysis this was a decision that would have to be made by NATO. However, I said, President Kennedy had been anxious to remove those missiles from Turkey and Italy for a long period of time. He had ordered their removal some time ago, and it was our judgement that, within a short time after this crisis was over, those missiles would be gone.[59]

Rusk's account, published in 1990, is that:

> I suggested that since the Jupiters in Turkey were coming out in any event, we should inform the Russians of this so that this irrelevant question would not complicate the solution of the missile sites in Cuba. We agreed that Bobby should inform Ambassador Dobrynin orally. Shortly after we returned to our